



* MARK HAVEN BRITT *
MONUMENT



Monument, Chapter I

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*"If a house be divided against itself,
that house cannot stand."*

RED LETTER DAY

September 1993

In an effort to put his humble hometown of NORFOLK, MASSACHUSETTS on the map, James Donovan Walker III set out to construct the world's tallest building.

It was designed to stand twenty stories taller than the recently completed Empire State Building.

The Walker Building was to be an exquisite model of modern architecture.

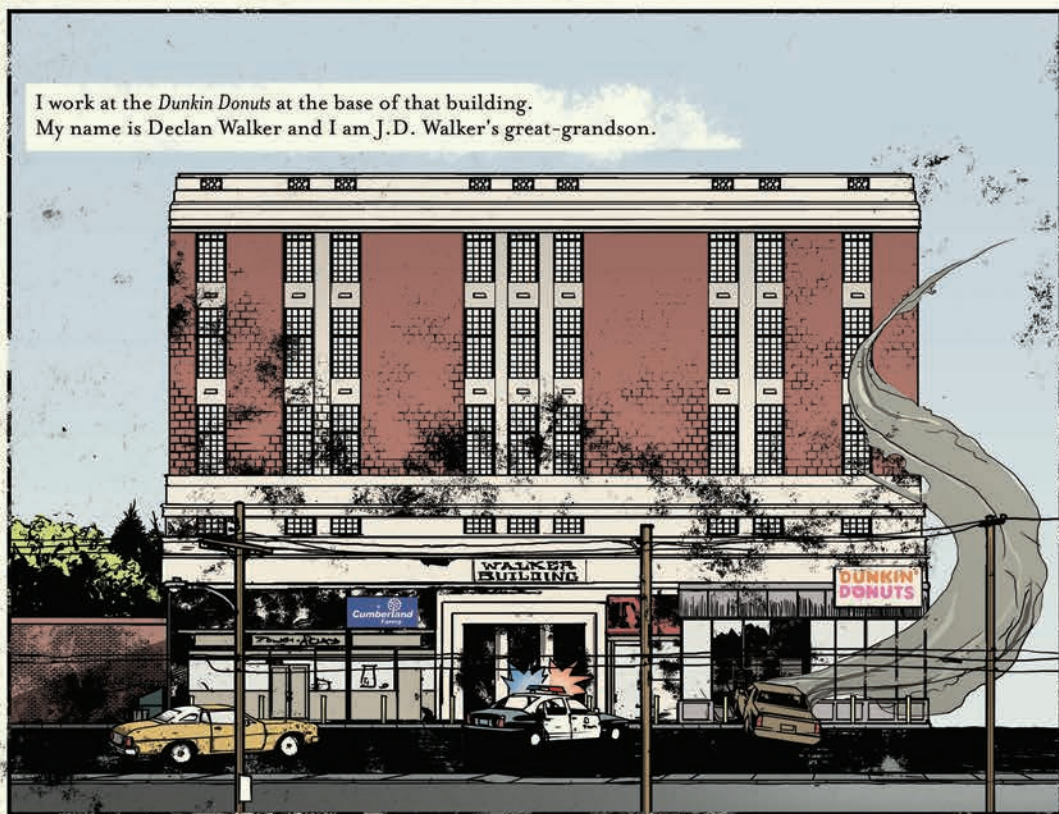
Only four stories had been completed when—through a combination of clerical errors, double-crosses and outright mistakes—Walker went bankrupt.

Construction was halted and the stunted Walker Building was sold in 1933. Sixty years later, it still stands at the center of town.





I work at the *Dunkin Donuts* at the base of that building.
My name is Declan Walker and I am J.D. Walker's great-grandson.

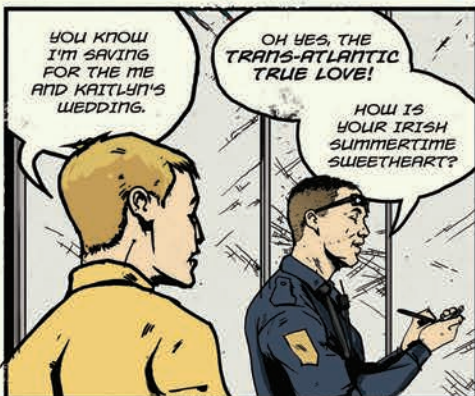
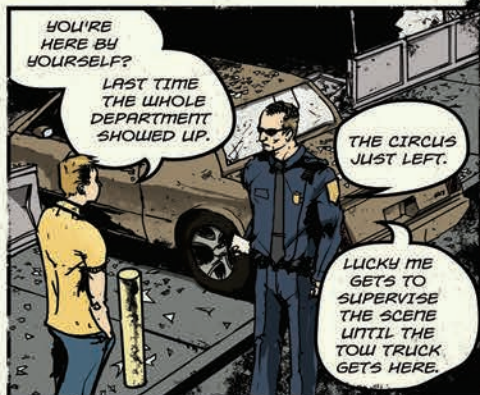


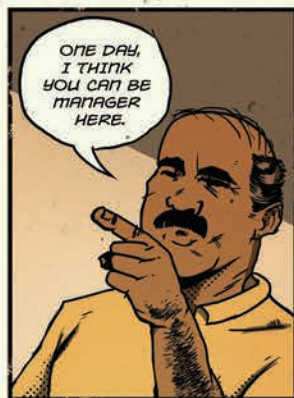
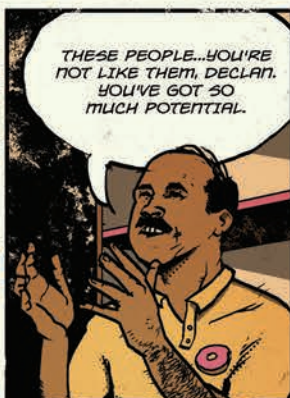


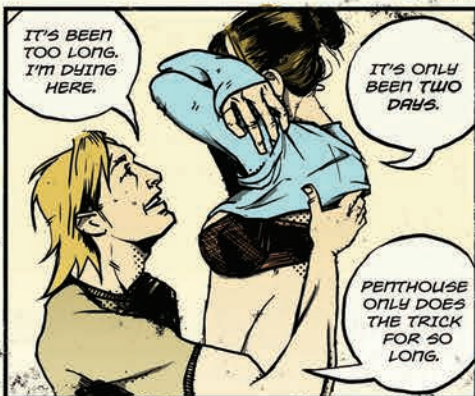
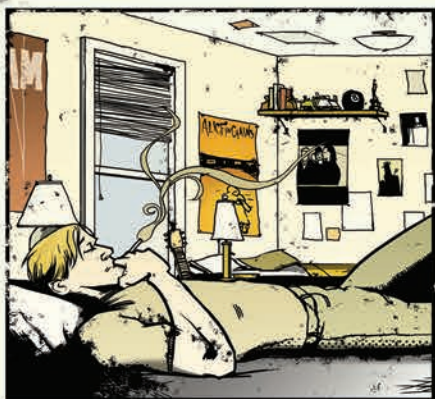
I've known Sully since I joined St. Joseph's Catholic Youth Organization and he's always been a good egg.

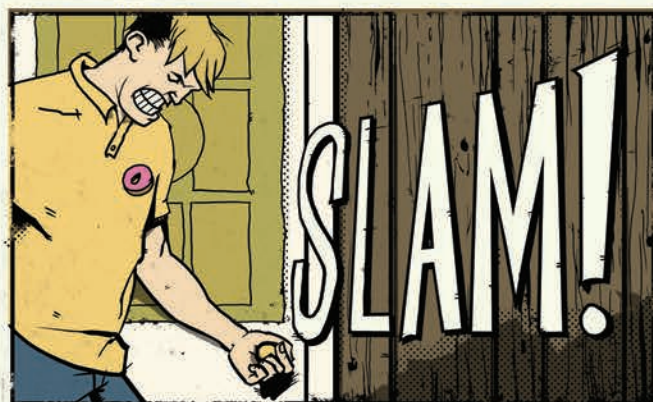
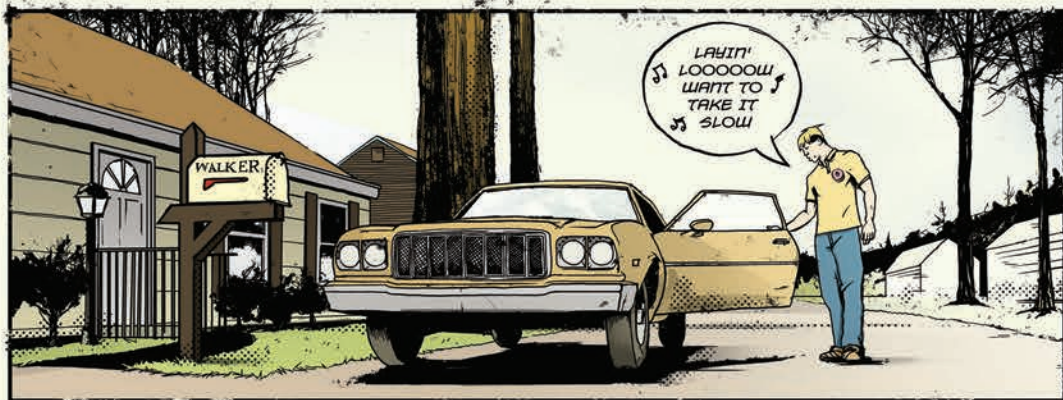
My father told me once, though, that when Sully was in junior high school he broke his best friend's jaw.

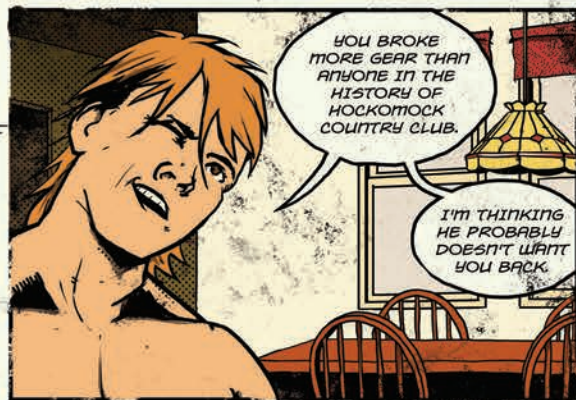
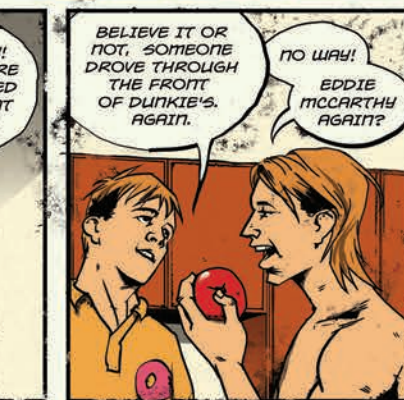
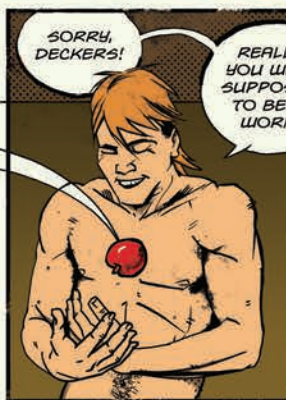
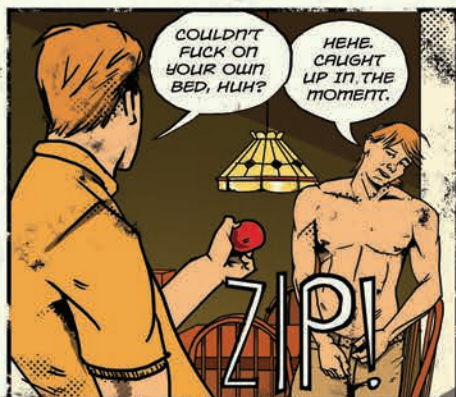
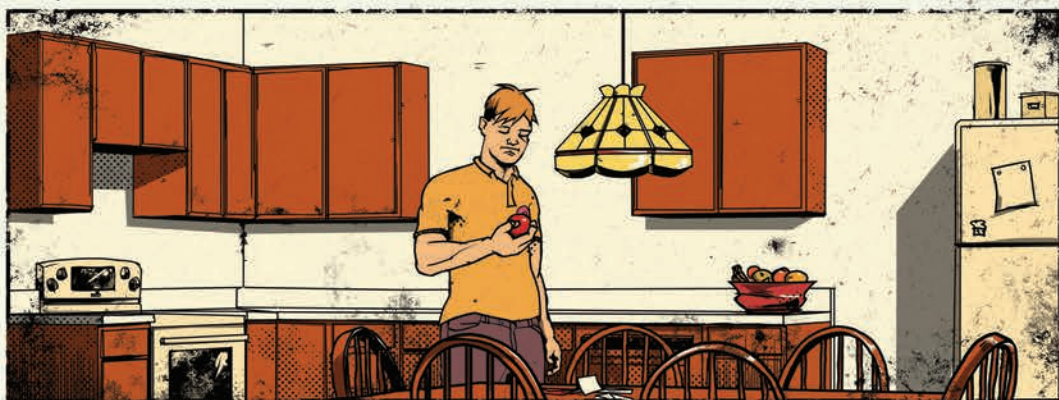
Sully doesn't remember what his friend said, nor does he remember unloading the devastating punch, but he'll never forget the strangely quiet moan that seemed to come straight from his best friend's chest.

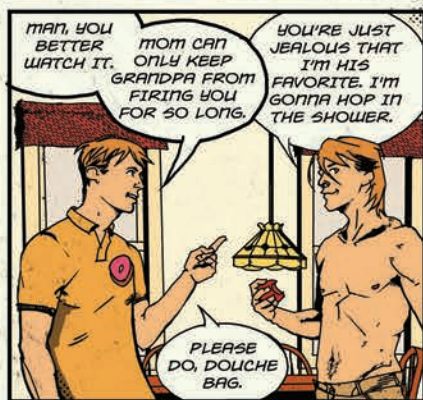
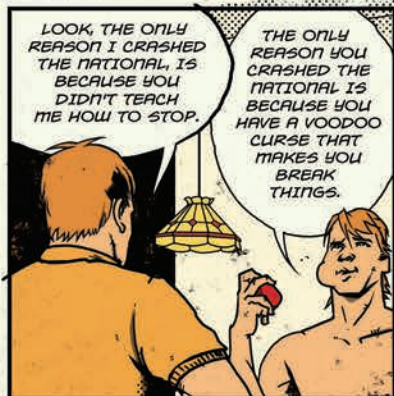
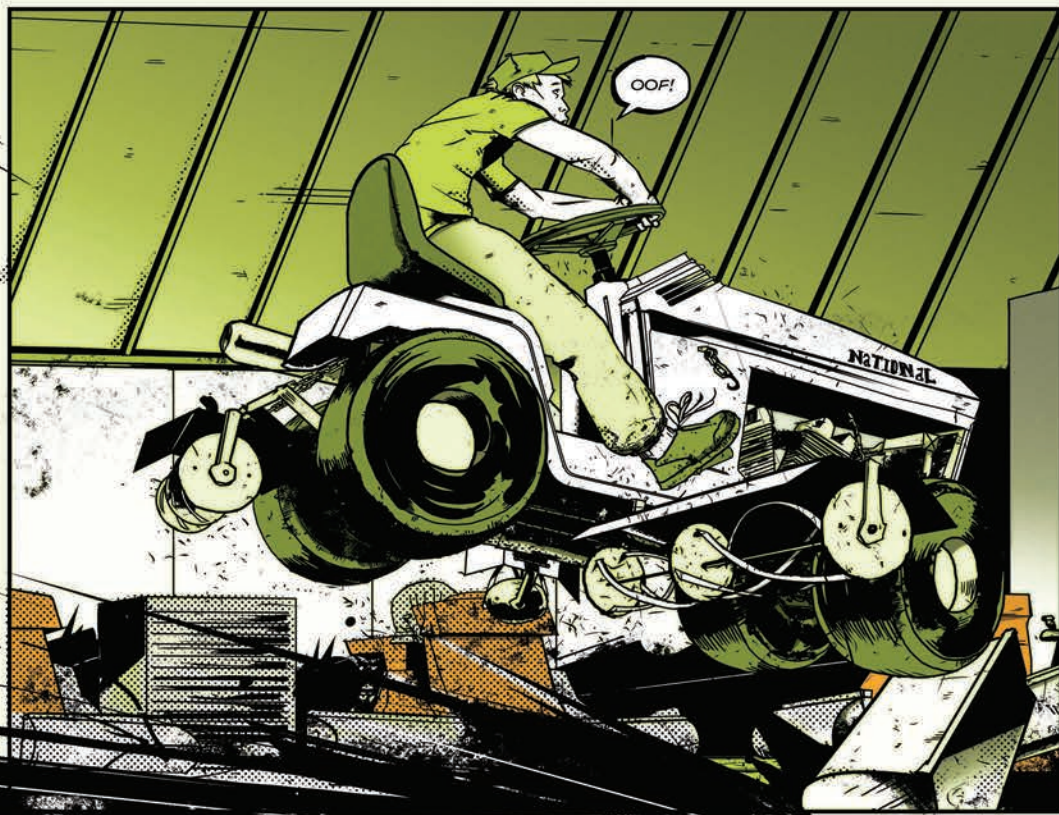


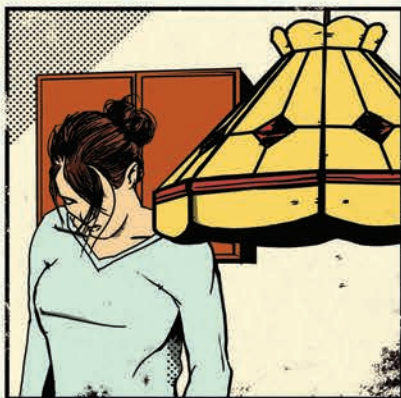












"Though the sewing of seeds
built the roots of our town,
Sometimes saving the garden
means burning trees down.
So it's my solemn task
to reveal what I see,
That there's deep-rooted rot
in your family tree.

"While in robes of decorum
your Grandfather's clad,
It is God's honest truth:
your Grandpa's your real Dad.

"As he toils each day
in sweet Norfolk's twilight,
This dark secret he's feared
would some day come to light.
Though the greens of his golf course
cannot be surpassed,
Out from Eden, most green,
even Adam was cast.



at 10:30
mass
♥ Mom



People always dog Roman Catholic priests. I can't blame them. Who in their right mind would remain celibate?

On top of that, most of the priests I know are bizarre and out of touch.

THANKS FATHER.

HEY! MOM!

But Winters was always my shining example of a good priest.

He smoked, drove like a maniac, and swore like a sailor. He was funny, down to earth, and always there when you needed him.

HEY FATHER WINTERS.

MOM, HAVE YOU SEEN GRANDPA?

I NEED TO FIND HIM. I CALLED HIM BUT HE'S NOT HOME.

NO, I HAVEN'T. HE WASN'T AT MASS TODAY.

HE'S PROBABLY AT JIMMY'S LUNCH.

HE NEVER GOLFS ON SUNDAYS.

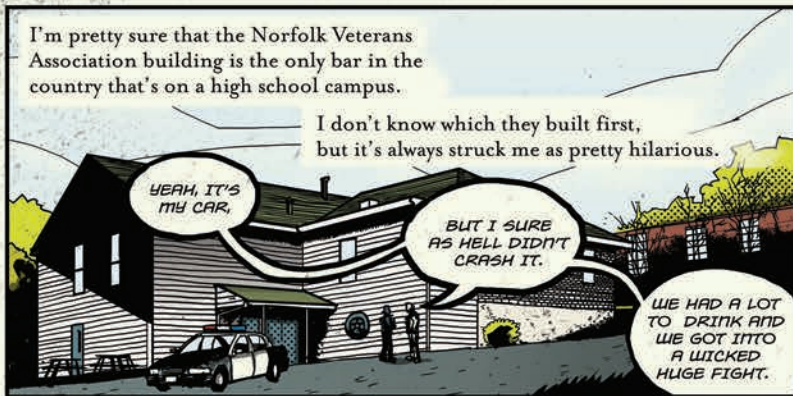
OH YEAH. GOOD. I'LL TRY THERE.

IS EVERYTHING ALRIGHT, DECLAN?

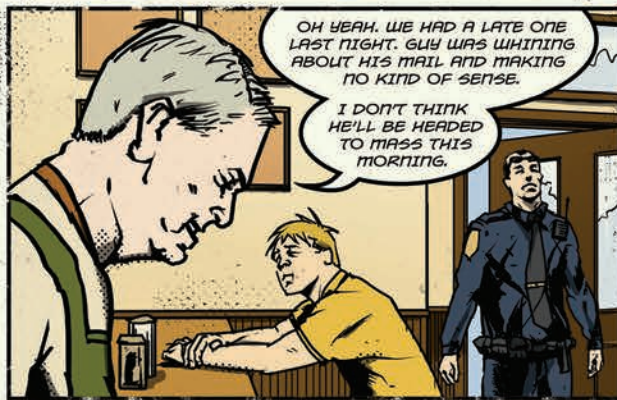
YEAH. I JUST... NEED SOME HELP FINDING A JOB.

WHAT HAPPENED TO YOUR JOB AT DUNKIN' DONUTS?

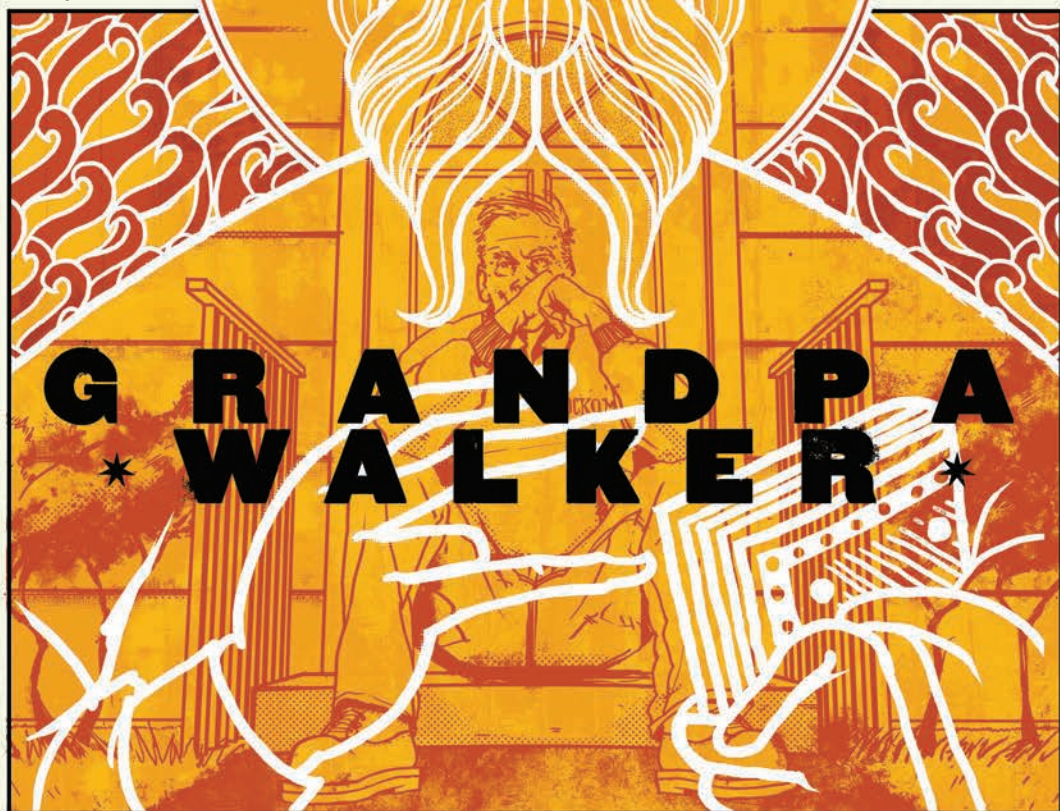
UH...ASK SULLY ABOUT THAT WHEN YOU SEE HIM!

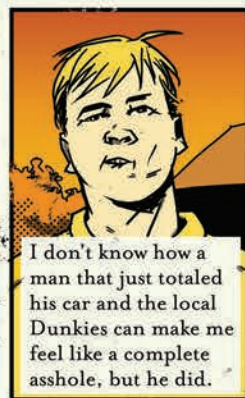
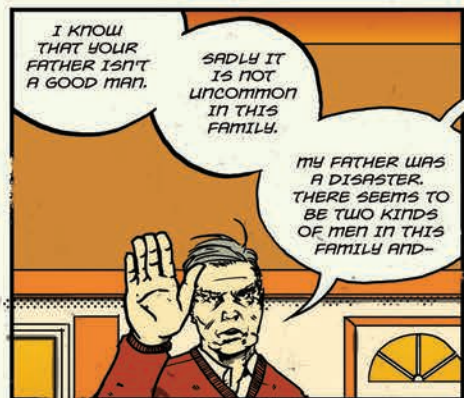
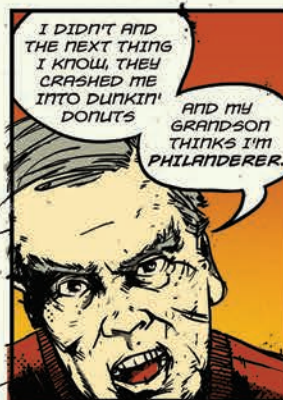














"From the bosom of Norfolk a child's disappeared
And I'm sorry to say that it's worse than you've feared..."

"Like a virgin's virginity after the prom,
There are some things that lost are eternally gone.



"Just to give you a chance to prove what you are worth,
There are secrets afoot I will help you unearth.





"You're like John McClane, while Chief's Inspector Clouseau,
So it's you that the boy's resting place I will show."

I had no idea that everyone in town received a letter that night.

I went to bed dreaming of Kaitlyn
and the summer shores of Galway...

NEXT
PUNCH
* A *
PRIEST

MONUMENT

next issue



MONUMENT

A classic pop record as a comic book

High school senior Declan Sullivan just returned to Norfolk, a predominantly Irish Catholic Boston suburb, from a summer church trip to Ireland. After a summer spent gazing across the sea with his new Irish girlfriend, Kaitlyn, Declan returns home with a bold new direction and an engagement to Kaitlyn. This year he'll save his money for the wedding, bring Kaitlyn to the States and join the Coast Guard after he graduates high school. His family thinks he's crazy and some of his friends doubt Kaitlyn's existence.

Shortly after Declan's return, the town is shaken by a mysterious murder of a classmate of Declan's. The murderer is still on the loose and everyone is on edge.

To make matters worse, letters telling deep dark secrets begin to appear in mailboxes all over the town of Norfolk. One letter details the school principal's drinking problem. Another tells a young student that his real father is someone his mother had an affair with. Another reveals a priest's molestation of a child parishioner. Will a letter arrive revealing who murdered the local high school student? Who will get one next? The letters seem targeted to tear apart the very fabric of this community.

While the letters haunt Norfolk, its citizens try to keep living their lives. Teenagers raise hell. They fall in and out of love. Hockey games on the frozen reservoir continue. The school musical goes on, albeit as a fiasco. Parents work their jobs, attempting to keep things together, knowing their quiet town could change at any moment.

MONUMENT is a bittersweet tale of suburban life. Quirky and sincere, MONUMENT is a classic pop record in comic book form.

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